

5876 Stoltze Rd

Static Website Build Brief

Detailed implementation guide for building the site in VS Code with GitHub Copilot and publishing to GitHub Pages

Primary goal	Create a polished single-page static website that presents the property as a rare private mountaintop retreat with a national-park / West Coast landscape feel.
Build approach	Use VS Code and GitHub Copilot for local development, then deploy the final static site to GitHub Pages with a custom domain.
Image workflow	Developer should create the site skeleton and an img folder. The owner will later place selected property photos into that folder and update the file references if needed.
Design direction	National park, mountain, arbutus trees, panoramic valley views, warm earth tones, clean typography, and a premium but natural feel.

This document is intended to be handed to a developer or used directly as a build brief while working in VS Code with Copilot.

1. Project objective

Build a static marketing website for the 5876 Stoltze Rd property that is visually distinctive, easy to browse, lightweight, and simple to host on GitHub Pages. The site should feel closer to a high-quality national park microsite than a generic real estate template. It should present the property as a private mountaintop retreat with dramatic valley views, native arbutus character, rocky terrain, open sky, and strong off-grid independence.

The deliverable should be a single long homepage. It should work well on desktop first, then adapt cleanly to tablet and mobile. The site must avoid a dense “listing portal” feeling and instead tell a visual story through large photography, restrained copy, and carefully chosen sections.

2. Required technology stack

- Static front-end only. No CMS and no server-side runtime are required.
- Use standard HTML, CSS, and JavaScript or a lightweight framework that can export to static files. For simplicity and GitHub Pages compatibility, plain HTML/CSS/JS or Vite is preferred.
- The project must be easy to open and edit in VS Code.
- GitHub Copilot should be used to accelerate scaffolding, section styling, image gallery logic, responsive polish, and deployment configuration.

- The output must be deployable to GitHub Pages without any paid infrastructure.
- The codebase should remain simple enough that the owner can later replace text and images manually.

3. Build environment expectations

The developer should assume the owner will work locally in VS Code and may ask Copilot to iterate on individual sections. The code should therefore be organized in a clean and readable way, with obvious file names, short components or sections, and commented image references where useful.

- Repository should include a clear README.md with local run instructions.
- Use relative image paths so the same code works locally and on GitHub Pages.
- Avoid dependencies that make GitHub Pages deployment fragile or overly complex.
- If a bundler is used, configure the base path correctly for GitHub Pages.

4. Design direction

The overall look and feel should match the following visual idea: national park, mountain overlook, arbutus trees, panoramic valley views, warm sunlight, rocky West Coast terrain, and an elevated sense of calm. The visual language should feel premium and memorable, but not flashy or corporate.

- Use a warm natural color palette: forest green, moss, cedar / bark brown, sandstone, mist, sky blue, and soft cream backgrounds.
- Avoid black luxury aesthetics, neon accents, glossy gradients, and high-tech styling.
- Typography should feel clean and refined. Headings should have presence without looking formal or old-fashioned.
- Spacing should be generous. The site should breathe.
- Buttons and cards should feel subtle and grounded, not overly rounded or app-like.
- The hero section should be highly photographic and immersive.
- Small visual details may echo park signage, trail maps, or interpretive displays, but only in a tasteful and modern way.

5. Content and messaging priorities

The website should emphasize the following story, in this general order of importance:

1. The setting: a rare 40-acre private mountaintop property in the Cowichan Valley.
2. The views: panoramic valley and mountain views, with visible water glimpses and unusual sunrise / sunset exposure.
3. The landscape character: arbutus trees, rocky outcrops, forest, trails, and open-sky exposure.
4. The lifestyle: privacy, independence, nature, recreation, and low utility dependence.
5. The home and systems: efficient 2-bedroom home, major solar/battery infrastructure, private well, septic, heating, and upgrades.
6. The convenience: still within practical reach of shopping, services, schools, and the hospital.

6. Single-page site structure

The homepage should include the following sections in approximately this order. The exact naming can change, but the structure should remain recognizable.

- A. Header / navigation — Simple top nav with anchor links to major sections. Keep navigation compact and elegant.
- B. Hero section — Large immersive hero using a dramatic landscape or aerial image. Include headline, short supporting copy, and a primary call-to-action such as “Explore the property” or “View gallery”.
- C. Quick highlights band — Compact highlights such as 40 acres, 2 bed / 1 bath, 1,282 sq ft, 15+ kW solar, 40 kWh battery, off-grid living.
- D. Executive summary — Short narrative section positioning the property as rare, private, scenic, and self-reliant.
- E. Image-led gallery — A visually strong gallery using real property images. This should replace the earlier placeholders. Use a mix of wide and medium tiles.
- F. Why this property stands out — Bulleted or card-based section covering privacy, views, arbutus / landscape, off-grid infrastructure, and convenience.
- G. Systems and infrastructure — Cards or feature blocks for solar, battery, well, septic, heating, internet, and low-dependence living.
- H. Major improvements timeline — A concise improvements section showing major upgrades by year.
- I. Location and lifestyle — Section about nearby parks, river, trails, Lake Cowichan, Cowichan River Provincial Park, shopping, and hospital access.
- J. Zoning / flexibility — Concise section on F-1 zoning and possible future flexibility, with appropriate cautionary wording.
- K. FAQ — Short practical questions: off-grid? internet? vehicle access? ongoing utilities?
- L. Contact / next step footer — Room for future contact info, downloadable information package, and optional map / inquiry CTA.

7. Image strategy and placeholder replacement plan

The developer should build the site in a way that all major image areas already point to real file names inside an img folder. The owner will then drop the selected files into that folder and can later swap them without reworking the whole site.

Important instruction for the developer: create the site skeleton first, including an img folder, and wire the layout to image files with clear descriptive names. The owner will place the final photos into that folder.

Recommended image folder structure

At minimum, create the following structure:

Path	
/img/hero-main.jpg	Main hero image

/img/gallery-aerial-home.jpg	Aerial shot showing house and landscape
/img/gallery-valley-wide.jpg	Wide valley / mountain panorama
/img/gallery-arbutus-frame.jpg	Arbutus-framed landscape view
/img/gallery-rocky-outlook.jpg	Rocky outcrop / lookout image
/img/gallery-home-exterior.jpg	Best home exterior image
/img/gallery-lawn-solar.jpg	Yard / solar / outdoor living image
/img/gallery-sunset.jpg	Sunset or golden-hour image
/img/gallery-wildlife.jpg	Wildlife / lifestyle detail if used
/img/location-map.jpg	Optional location visual or custom map

Suggested photo usage from current property set

- Use one of the strongest panoramic aerial or valley images as the hero.
- Use the arbutus-framed image in the gallery to reinforce the West Coast park character.
- Use at least one image that clearly shows the house in context, not just the house itself.
- Use one sunset or golden-hour image to support the “sunrise and sunset” story.
- Use one image that shows rocky terrain / lookout character to make the setting feel distinctive.
- Use one image with wildlife only if it adds charm and does not make the site feel gimmicky.

8. Explicit developer request

Please create the project skeleton and the img folder first. Do not wait for the final photo curation before wiring the image paths. Use the naming structure above or a similarly clear naming system. I will place the actual property photos into the img folder and can later adjust any file names if needed.

Also set up the skeleton so the site can be previewed locally immediately, even before final copy and final image selection are complete.

9. Suggested project structure

A clean folder structure is important because the owner will likely edit the project directly in VS Code and use Copilot for follow-up improvements.

File / folder	Notes
index.html	Single-page site entry if using plain static HTML.
/css/styles.css	Main theme, layout, colors, gallery, responsive styling.
/js/main.js	Optional interactivity such as sticky nav, lightbox, or section animation.

/img/	All local site images placed here.
README.md	How to run locally, how to update images, how to deploy.
CNAME	Custom domain file for GitHub Pages when ready.
.github/workflows/	Optional GitHub Pages workflow if using a build step.

10. Functional requirements

- Responsive layout for desktop, tablet, and mobile.
- Fast loading and optimized image display.
- Anchor navigation to key sections.
- Gallery that looks polished even if later images are swapped manually.
- Readable text over image backgrounds with proper contrast.
- No broken layout if an image has a slightly different crop.
- Clean footer with room for contact details and downloadable information package.
- Basic SEO setup: title tag, meta description, favicon placeholder, Open Graph tags if practical.

11. Recommended visual details

- Hero image can use a soft overlay for readability, but do not flatten or dull the landscape too much.
- Use subtle dividers, topographic or grain-like texture, or park-map inspired accents only if they remain understated.
- Gallery tiles should feel editorial, not like a basic real estate slideshow.
- Use muted greens and warm neutrals for cards and section backgrounds.
- The design should preserve a sense of place: mountain air, open light, native trees, and quiet privacy.

12. GitHub Pages deployment requirements

The final website will be hosted on GitHub Pages and later connected to a custom domain. The project must therefore be easy to publish from a GitHub repository without any backend.

- If using plain HTML/CSS/JS, deployment should work by serving the repository root or docs folder.
- If using Vite or another static bundler, configure build output and base path correctly for GitHub Pages.
- Include a CNAME file when the custom domain is ready.
- Avoid absolute local paths; use relative asset references that survive deployment.
- Document the deployment steps clearly in the README.

13. GitHub Copilot usage suggestions

The build should be structured so Copilot can easily help with further refinements. Suggested Copilot tasks include:

- Generate the initial static site skeleton and section markup.

- Refine the CSS palette into a national-park inspired theme.
- Create a responsive masonry or editorial gallery layout.
- Add subtle scroll effects or section reveal animations.
- Help refactor repetitive markup into reusable components if a framework is used.
- Generate the GitHub Pages workflow or deployment instructions.

14. Acceptance criteria

The project should be considered ready for first review when all of the following are true:

7. A developer can clone the repository and run a local preview in VS Code without confusion.
8. The homepage is fully structured and styled, even if final text and images are not yet perfect.
9. An img folder already exists and all major image references point to clear descriptive file names.
10. The design clearly reads as national park / mountain / West Coast rather than generic real estate or tech-luxury.
11. The current property photos can be dropped in with minimal code changes.
12. The project can be deployed to GitHub Pages cleanly.

15. Immediate next-step checklist for the developer

- Create the repository and initial project skeleton.
- Create the img folder and pre-wire all image references.
- Build the single-page layout with all required sections.
- Apply the national-park / mountain / arbutus design system.
- Insert temporary or owner-provided property images to show the intended visual result.
- Test the site locally in VS Code.
- Prepare GitHub Pages deployment configuration.
- Write a short README describing local preview, image replacement, and publishing steps.

16. Final note to include in handoff

Please start by creating the full skeleton and img folder structure. I will place the selected property photos into the img folder. Build the site so I can open it in VS Code, use Copilot to continue refining it, and publish it to GitHub Pages with a custom domain when ready.